



ADDING FIRE TO FIREFOX

The best plugins to better the best browser

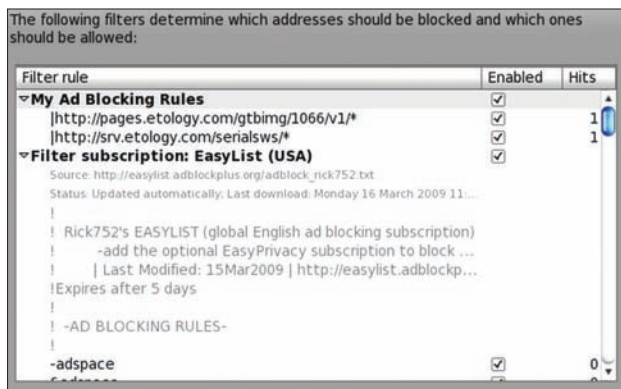
Kumar Jhuremalani

Mozilla Firefox is a good browser. But that shouldn't stop us from adding to it – more colour, or customisation in general. At the same time it should be efficient at its main task of browsing. The best thing here is that Firefox permits numerous ways of customisation. But before we come to that, you need to understand how to download add-ons for Firefox.

First, go to www.mozilla.com and search for add-ons. With the new version of Firefox, you can just go to Tools > Add-ons from the menubar. Then from the Get Add-ons tab, you can search the exact name of the add-on you want to install and start customising. This is another addition to Firefox.

Adblock Plus

This is an absolute must for Firefox. With Adblock Plus, you will be able to keep those AD banners that slow down your browsing experience, or serve only to irritate your senses, in check. When you install this add-on, you can subscribe to a filter that gets updated almost every day. For



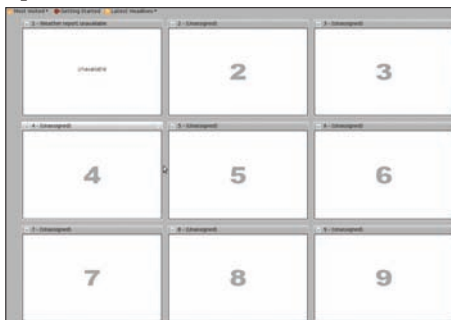
Block those pesky ADs using Adblock

anything that slips past this filter, you just need to right-click a banner AD and select Adblock Frame or Adblock Image; the AD is now permanently blocked. In the preferences window, you will see a whole list of blocked image URLs and also the hits these images received. You can also add manual URLs as filters through the preferences window. This is the first thing you should install on Firefox. If you have been using Firefox for long and have not installed this yet, do it immediately.

Managing tabs and bookmarks

Speed Dial

Let's start off with a small add-on that



Speed Dial is a nice way to quickly launch a site

gives you the option of easily accessing your favourite web sites. It displays your web sites as a grid where you can access them by a single-click. This feature is already present in Opera, but is very useful and hence is a suggested add-on for Firefox. With the Speed Dial extension, you can set the number of rows and columns in the layout and also create dial groups. Other customisation includes the size of the browser background and also the shortcuts for each tab.

Tab Mix Plus

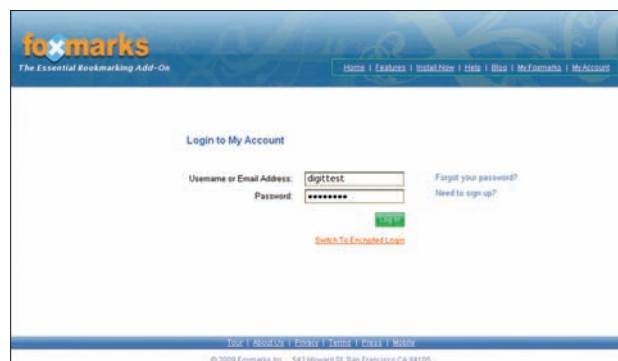
This add-on gives you full control of your tabs, right from allowing all your tabs to fit on the screen by increasing the number of tab bars to even customising what a double-click on a single tab can do.



Tab Mix Plus offers complete control over your Firefox tabs

To access the options for Tab Mix Plus go to Tools > Tab Mix Plus Options. Options present here include Links, Events, Display, Mouse, Menu and Session. In Links, you can set how you want your link to open – either in a new tab or a new window. Events has many more options such as Tab Focus and Tab Merging. In Display options, you can set Firefox to hold multiple tab bars so all your tabs can fit your screen. You can also change the position of your tab bar from the top to the bottom of your browser. Under Mouse, you can customise mouse gestures. You can set the mouse to just hover over the tab and that tab comes forward, without clicking. You can set double-click to rename a tab. On right-clicking a tab, more options are displayed – ranging from duplicating tabs to locking and protecting tabs. These options can be set under the Menu tab, where you can select or deselect the options you want to use. Tab Mix Plus also comes with a session manager which means if your browser crashes, your session will be safe and can be restored.

Additional features with this add-on include locking and protecting tabs. When you lock a tab, everything else will open in a new tab and when you protect a tab, that particular tab can't be closed. It also keeps a list of closed tabs and you can even Undo a Closed Tab. Another great feature is that when you use [Ctrl]+[Tab] it does not just go to the next tab but goes directly to the tab you were last using.



Foxmarks is a great bookmark manager